BRAND GUIDE · OCTOBER 2026

Afterglow

The light only ever deepens.

Four stages, two faces, one grid. Everything in this guide applies to any medium: screen, paper, film, surface.

Values are rendered from the token file the build consumes, so a number here and a number in the code cannot disagree.

The wordmark

There is no drawn logotype. The wordmark is the typeface, which keeps it reproducible by anyone holding this guide.



CONSTRUCTION

Set in Instrument Serif at 400, tracking 0, no optical adjustment. There is no drawn logotype: the wordmark is the typeface, which is what keeps it reproducible by anyone who has the guide.

CLEAR SPACE

The cap height of the A on every side, measured from the bounding box of the word. At the minimum size of 96 px, or 24 mm in print, that is 24 px.

Misuse

Six ways to break it. Each one is a thing the system cannot absorb, not a matter of taste.

DO NOT RECOLOUR

Outside the four stages and the two text neutrals.

DO NOT STRETCH

No horizontal or vertical scaling, ever.

DO NOT OUTLINE

No stroke, no shadow, no glow. Shadow is not in the system.

DO NOT STACK

One line. The word does not break.

DO NOT SET SMALL ON THE FALL

Below 24 px it fails its floor somewhere on the ramp.

DO NOT SUBSTITUTE

If the face is unavailable the wordmark is set as an image, not in a fallback.

The four stages

One ramp. Lightness falls and chroma stays flat at 0.110 throughout, so the stages differ in depth rather than in intensity.

Gold of last light

HEX	OKLCH	CMYK	PANTONE
#D8B260	0.781 0.110 84.9	0 18 56 15	*match on proof*

After gold

HEX	OKLCH	CMYK	PANTONE
#BC6F4C	0.619 0.110 44.7	0 41 60 26	*match on proof*

Rose

HEX	OKLCH	CMYK	PANTONE
#893A50	0.461 0.110 5.0	0 58 42 46	*match on proof*

Deep violet

HEX	OKLCH	CMYK	PANTONE
#341D5E	0.301 0.110 295.2	45 69 0 63	*match on proof*

CMYK is converted from sRGB for a proof, not matched. A Pantone is an inked colour under controlled light and cannot be derived from a hex, so each is left to be matched against a physical guide and written back here.

Contrast and roles

Every ratio is computed from the token. The body floor is 4.5:1 and the large-text floor is 3:1; a role is what the number allows.

STAGE	ON VOID	ON #141414	ON #2B2B2B	TEXT ON IT	ROLE
Gold of last light	**9.97:1**	**9.17:1**	**7.05:1**	**1.70:1**	Text, marks, rules
After gold	**5.26:1**	**4.84:1**	**3.72:1**	**3.23:1**	Text, marks, rules
Rose	**2.66:1**	**2.44:1**	**1.88:1**	**6.40:1**	Ground only
Deep violet	**1.41:1**	**1.30:1**	**1.00:1**	**12.01:1**	Ground only

- Clears the body floor on the void at 9.97:1. Usable as a letterform at any size, in any medium.
- Clears the body floor on the void at 5.26:1. Usable as a letterform at any size, in any medium.
- Reads 2.66:1 on the void, under every text floor. A ground, never a letterform.
- Reads 1.41:1 on the void, under every text floor. A ground, never a letterform.

Neutrals and surfaces

Six tokens that are not on the ramp. Elevation is carried by the two surface steps, which is why there is no shadow in the system.

TOKEN	VALUE	OKLCH L	CMYK	USE
Ground	#080808	0.134	0 0 0 97	Page ground. Required by the deepening-light rule, not borrowed
Surface, recessed	#141414	0.191	0 0 0 92	Recessed panels
Surface, raised	#2B2B2B	0.289	0 0 0 83	Cards and raised panels
Text	#EEECEA	0.944	0 1 2 7	Primary text
Muted	#C0C0C0	0.808	0 0 0 25	Secondary text
Border	rgba(192,192,192,0.22)	n/a	n/a	Hairline

The fall

The gradient is an asset with a specification, not an effect applied by eye. This page is an instance of it.



STOP	VALUE	POSITION	STAGE
1	#D8B260	0%	Gold of last light
2	#BC6F4C	33.33%	After gold
3	#893A50	66.67%	Rose
4	#341D5E	100%	Deep violet

RULES

- Gold to violet, top to bottom or left to right. Never reversed, because the one thing the ramp says is that the light deepens.
- Interpolated in sRGB. Specifying it in another space changes every intermediate value and the measured ratios stop holding.
- No stop may be added, moved or removed. Four stops, evenly spaced.
- Nothing smaller than 24 px of type sits directly on it. Type on the fall uses the floor for the darkest value it crosses.
- In print it is a four-colour build or a gradient mesh; it is not two spot inks, which cannot hold the middle.

Two faces, one scale

Both are in Shopify's library, so neither ships as a webfont. The scale is a ratio, not a list.

DISPLAY

Afterglow

Instrument Serif · 400 · headings and the wordmark

BODY

Afterglow

Space Grotesk · 400 · everything else

4XL	Deepening	61.04 px · 3.815 rem
3XL	Deepening	48.83 px · 3.052 rem
2XL	Deepening	39.06 px · 2.441 rem
XL	Deepening	31.25 px · 1.953 rem
LG	Deepening	25 px · 1.562 rem
MD	Deepening	20 px · 1.25 rem
BASE	Deepening	16 px · 1 rem
XS	Deepening	12.8 px · 0.8 rem

Setting for screen and print

The same hierarchy in both media, so a layout moves between them without being redrawn.

ROLE	SCREEN	PRINT	LEADING	TRACKING
Display	61.04–39.06 px	36–72 pt	1.02	−0.015 em
Heading	31.25 px	18–24 pt	1.1	−0.01 em
Body	16 px	9.5–11 pt	1.55	0
Caption	12.8 px	7–8 pt	1.45	0.08 em
Label	12.8 px uppercase	7 pt uppercase	1.3	0.12 em

BOTH MEDIA

Sizes are authored in rem on screen so a reader's font-size preference is respected, and in points in print. The ratio is the same 1.25 in both, from a 16 px base, so a layout can be moved between them without redrawing the hierarchy.

Grid and spacing

Twelve columns in both media and one spacing base that divides the type base.



MEASURE	SCREEN	PRINT
Columns	12	12
Gutter	24 px	4 mm
Margin	32–64 px	12 mm
Baseline	8 px	4 mm
Max measure	58 ch	58 ch

SPACING

2XS	4 px
XS	8 px
SM	12 px
MD	16 px
LG	24 px
XL	32 px
2XL	48 px
3XL	64 px

A 8 px base and whole multiples of it. Eight divides the 16 px type base, so space and text sit on one grid rather than two that nearly agree.

Radius, shadow, motion, and the one rule

Three values and the only rule in this document that can be checked automatically.

RADIUS

0

Square. Restraint and a dark ground point there.

SHADOW

none

Elevation reads through the two surface steps.

MOTION

450 ms

cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0.2, 1). Ends at its destination, never passes it.

THE ONE RULE

No state change brightens.

On screen that is hover, focus and active: they deepen or shift hue and never lighten. In print and in film it is the same rule about sequence: a later panel is never lighter than the one before it. It is the only rule here that can be checked in a diff, which is why it is written this way and not as a sentence about mood.

Art direction

The palette is a description of light at a particular hour. Images are made to match it rather than graded toward it afterwards.

One light source, and it is falling.

Images are made at the end of the day or lit to look as though they were.

The upper quartile of an image's lightness sits at or below the gold of last light, L 0.781.

Up to a quarter of the frame may pass it; the rest may not.

Warm to cool across a set, never back.

A sequence follows the ramp in the same direction the ramp runs.

Grade toward the stages rather than to neutral.

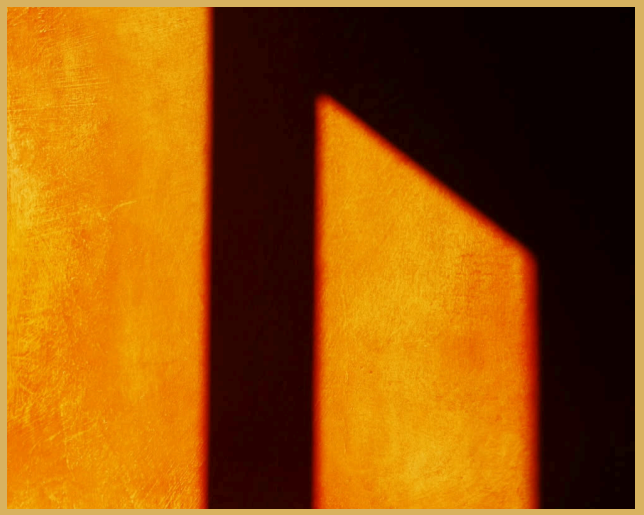
The palette is where the shadows and the highlights land.

Nothing is brightened in post.

Exposure is lifted at capture or the frame is not used.

Gold of last light

#D8B260 · L 0.781

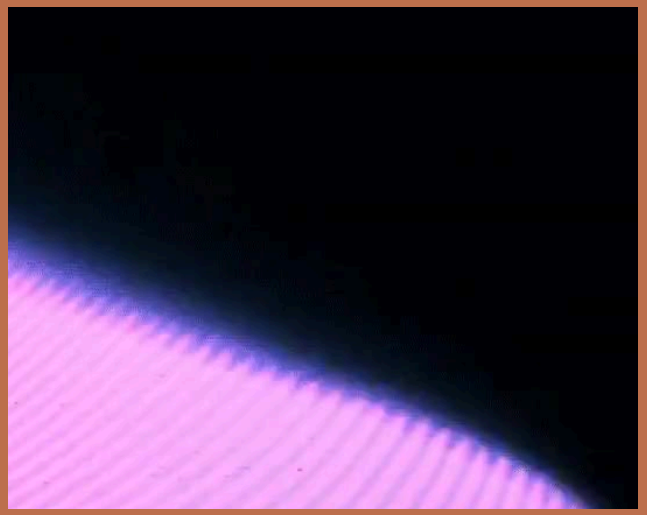







After gold

#BC6F4C · L 0.619



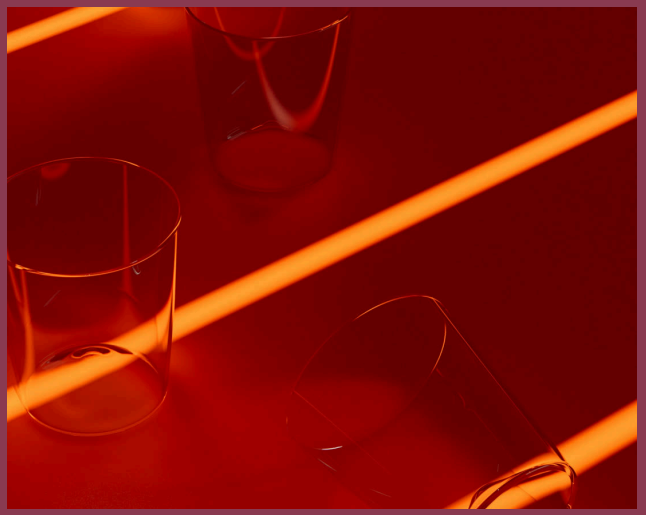





Rose

#893A50 · L 0.461








Deep violet

#341D5E · L 0.301

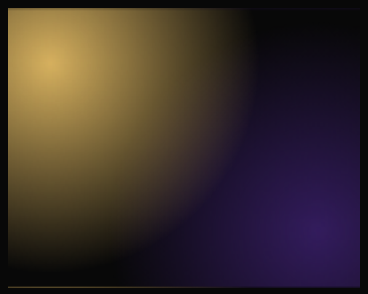







Misuse

Six ways to break the five rules. Each tile is built from tokens, so none of them is a photograph that would have to clear the ceiling.



TWO LIGHT SOURCES

Breaks one light source, and it is falling.



FLAT LIGHT

Breaks one light source, and it is falling: nothing falls.



OVER-LIT FRAME

Breaks the upper quartile at or below gold: over a quarter of it passes.



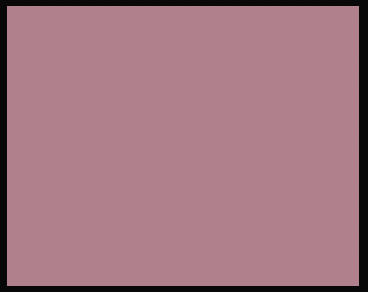
REVERSED SET

Breaks warm to cool, never back.



GRADED TO NEUTRAL

Breaks grade toward the stages rather than to neutral.



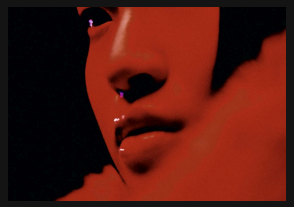
LIFTED IN POST

Breaks nothing is brightened in post: the shadows are raised.

Digital

The three things a storefront is mostly made of, in the tokens, and the imagery they sit with.

PRODUCT CARD



Afterglow

$180

BUTTON, REST AND HOVER

ADD TO CART

ADD TO CART

Hover deepens: L 0.781 to L 0.630

SURFACE STEPS

Recessed #141414

Raised #2B2B2B

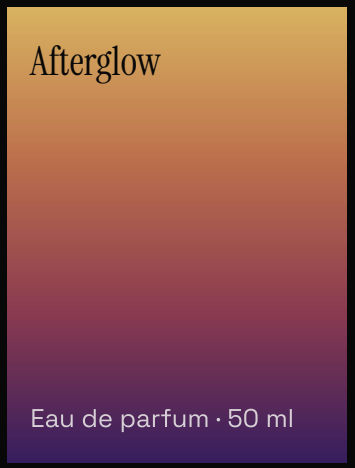
Print and production

What the fall needs from a press, and what will break it.

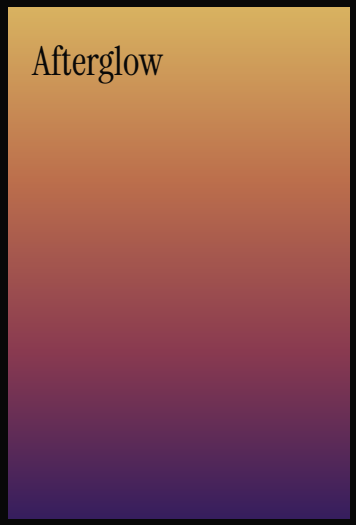
CARD, 85 × 55 MM



LABEL FACE



POSTER, 2:3



PRODUCTION

- The fall prints as a four-colour build or a gradient mesh. Two spot inks cannot hold the middle of the ramp.
- Uncoated stock shifts the ramp cooler and flattens the violet end. Proof on the stock, not on a house sheet.
- Flat bands are the failure mode of a long gradient on paper. Keep any one flat under an inch at the size it is printed.
- No placed image has an upper quartile above gold, L 0.781. Checked on the file, not on the proof.
- No varnish or foil on the fall. A specular finish reverses the one rule wherever the light catches it.

Voice, and where the rules stop

The visual system and the voice stop in the same place, which is not an accident.

VOICE

Unhurried and physical. It names heat, light, breath and skin. It describes a sequence, because the product is a sequence. Certain without pushing: the brand does not argue for itself, and assumes you will understand it if you are shown it in the right order.

WHERE THE RULES STOP

Cart, checkout, shipping notices, legal and safety copy are plain and fast. The atmosphere stops there on purpose, exactly as the voice does. Applied to a payment form or a warning label the discipline makes it worse.

ELSEWHERE

The full voice, the word lists and the tone by context live in voice-tone.md. Event art direction for the launch is in the brief and governs that night only; nothing in it binds the brand.